

IT Helpdesk Knowledge Base

Synthetic Internal Support Guide • VPN, Password Reset, Hardware Requests & Troubleshooting

Organization: Horizon Peak Solutions

Purpose: This knowledge base provides employees and IT support staff with standardized procedures for common IT requests. It is designed as a fictional example for training, testing, and documentation.

Important: Never share passwords, MFA codes, recovery codes, or other authentication secrets with the Helpdesk.

1. Helpdesk Overview

The Horizon Peak IT Helpdesk is the first point of contact for workstation, account, connectivity, software, and access issues.

Support Area	Primary Contact	Typical Issues
General IT	IT Helpdesk	Login, applications, connectivity
Identity & Access	Access Team	Password, MFA, account access
Network	Network Team	VPN, Wi-Fi, DNS, connectivity
Hardware	Device Team	Laptop, monitor, keyboard, peripherals
Security	Security Operations	Suspicious activity, phishing, lost devices

Support Channels

- **Helpdesk Portal:** <https://example.com/horizonpeak/helpdesk>
- **IT Support Email:** helpdesk@example.com
- **Knowledge Base:** <https://example.com/horizonpeak/kb>
- **Emergency IT Channel:** [#it-critical](#)

All URLs and addresses in this document are fictional placeholders.

2. Ticket Priority

Priority	Description	Example	Target Response
P1 — Critical	Major business or security impact	Company-wide authentication outage	15 minutes
P2 — High	Significant individual/team impact	Unable to access critical application	1 hour
P3 — Normal	Standard support request	VPN troubleshooting	4 business hours
P4 — Low	General request or information	Hardware accessory request	1 business day

3. VPN Access & Troubleshooting

The corporate VPN provides secure access to internal applications and services when employees work from an untrusted or external network.

Before Connecting

- Confirm the device has an active internet connection.
- Verify the correct VPN client is installed.
- Confirm your company account is active.
- Make sure your device date and time are correct.
- Complete required MFA verification.

Standard VPN Connection Procedure

- Open the approved Horizon Peak VPN application.
- Select the company profile.
- Enter your corporate username.
- Complete MFA using the approved method.
- Wait for the connection status to show Connected.
- Open the required internal application.

VPN Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely Cause	Recommended Action
Cannot sign in	Incorrect credentials or account lock	Verify username and use password-reset process if necessary.
MFA fails	Device/app issue	Check device time, network, and approved MFA method.
Connection drops	Unstable network	Test internet connection and reconnect.
Connected but internal site unavailable	DNS/routing issue	Disconnect/reconnect and test another internal resource.
VPN client will not open	Application issue	Restart device and reinstall only through approved software process.

When to Escalate VPN Issues

- Multiple employees report simultaneous VPN failures.
- VPN authentication fails for an otherwise healthy account.
- The VPN gateway appears unavailable.
- The issue continues after approved troubleshooting.

4. Password Reset

Employees must use the approved self-service password recovery process whenever possible. Helpdesk staff should never ask for or receive the user's current password.

Self-Service Reset

- Open the company identity portal.
- Select 'Forgot Password'.
- Verify your identity using the approved recovery method.
- Create a new password that meets company requirements.
- Sign in again and complete MFA.
- Reconnect to VPN if required.

Password Requirements

- Use a long, unique password or approved passphrase.
- Do not reuse a company password on personal services.
- Do not share passwords through chat or email.
- Do not store passwords in plain text.
- Use the approved password manager where available.

Account Locked

If an account is locked after repeated failed attempts, stop trying random passwords. Use the account recovery process or contact the Helpdesk so the lockout can be investigated.

5. MFA Troubleshooting

Problem	First Steps	Escalation
New phone	Use approved MFA enrollment procedure	Identity & Access
Lost MFA device	Contact Helpdesk using identity-verification process	Identity & Access
Push not received	Check network and notification settings	Identity & Access
Incorrect verification code	Check device time and retry once	Identity & Access

6. Hardware Requests

Hardware requests are submitted through the Helpdesk portal and are reviewed according to role, availability, budget, and business need.

Common Hardware Requests

Request Type	Examples	Typical Information Required
Laptop	New employee or replacement	Role, manager, location, required software
Monitor	Additional or replacement display	Desk setup and business reason
Keyboard/Mouse	Standard or ergonomic equipment	Requested model and reason
Docking Station	Laptop desk setup	Laptop model and monitor count
Headset	Meetings and calls	Role and communication needs
Mobile Device	Approved business use	Business justification and manager approval

Hardware Request Process

- Submit a ticket through the Helpdesk portal.
- Select the correct hardware category.
- Provide a business justification.
- Include manager approval when required.
- IT checks inventory and compatibility.
- Approved equipment is assigned or ordered.
- Employee confirms receipt and asset details.

7. Lost or Stolen Equipment

Lost or stolen company equipment should be reported immediately, especially when the device may contain company information.

- Contact the Helpdesk or Security team immediately.
- Provide the device asset ID if known.
- Report the approximate time and location.
- Do not attempt to recover a stolen device yourself.
- Follow security instructions regarding account sessions and access.

Do not delay reporting because you are still searching for the device.

8. Laptop Troubleshooting

Slow Computer

- Restart the computer if it has been running for an extended period.
- Close unnecessary applications and browser tabs.
- Check available disk space.
- Install pending approved updates.
- If the issue persists, submit a Helpdesk ticket with the symptoms and approximate start time.

Application Not Responding

- Wait briefly to determine whether the application recovers.

- Save work if possible.
- Close and reopen the application.
- Restart the device if necessary.
- Report repeated failures with the application name and error message.

No Internet Connection

- Confirm Wi-Fi or Ethernet is enabled.
- Check whether other devices or websites have connectivity.
- Reconnect to the approved network.
- Restart the network adapter or device if appropriate.
- Contact Network Support if the issue affects multiple users.

9. Software Installation

Employees should install software through approved company-managed channels whenever possible.

- Use the company software portal.
- Do not install unapproved executables from unknown websites.
- Request administrator access only when required.
- Provide a business justification for non-standard software.
- IT may review software for licensing and security requirements.

10. Security Incident Reporting

Potential security incidents require immediate escalation rather than normal troubleshooting.

Situation	Action
Suspected phishing	Do not click further; report through the security process.
Credentials exposed	Change credentials through the approved process and contact Security.
Lost company laptop	Contact Helpdesk and Security immediately.
Unexpected MFA prompt	Reject the prompt and report it.
Suspicious software	Disconnect from network if instructed and contact Security.

11. Common Helpdesk Questions

How do I reset my password?

Use the self-service identity portal. If self-service recovery fails, contact the Helpdesk and complete the required identity-verification process.

Why does VPN say 'Connected' but internal applications do not work?

The VPN connection may be established while internal routing or DNS is unavailable. Disconnect and reconnect, test another internal resource, and escalate if the issue continues.

How do I request a new laptop?

Create a hardware request ticket with your role, manager, required software, location, and business justification.

Can the Helpdesk tell me my password?

No. Helpdesk staff should never know or request your password.

What if I receive an unexpected MFA request?

Reject the request and report it as a possible security incident.

12. Helpdesk Ticket Template

Subject: Short description of the issue

Device: Laptop / Desktop / Mobile

Application: Name and version, if known

Issue: What is happening?

Expected: What should happen?

Steps Tried: Troubleshooting already completed

Error: Exact error message, if available

Impact: Individual / Team / Organization

Time Started: Approximate date and time

13. Employee Self-Service Checklist

- I know how to access the Helpdesk portal.
- I know how to reset my password.
- I know how to connect to the corporate VPN.
- I know where to request hardware.
- I know how to report lost equipment.
- I know how to report a suspected security incident.
- I know never to share my password or MFA codes.

14. Escalation Matrix

Issue	Primary Team	Escalate When
VPN	Network Team	Multiple users affected or persistent gateway issue
Password/MFA	Identity & Access	Self-service recovery fails
Hardware	Device Team	Inventory unavailable or repeated device failure
Software	Application Support	Approved troubleshooting fails
Security	Security Operations	Credentials, phishing, suspicious activity, lost device

15. Final Reminder

The Helpdesk exists to help employees work safely and effectively. When reporting an issue, provide clear information, avoid sharing sensitive credentials, and report security concerns immediately.

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